

Sophos Hardware Sizing Tool

Account Manager, Sales Engineer & Partner Guide

This guide covers creating sizing links, the Flag !' SE Review !' export workflow, partner access, catalog admin (admins only), and how to reopen or correct a submission.

1. What this tool does

The Sophos Hardware Sizing tool turns a customer's environment details into a right-sized hardware recommendation for Sophos Firewalls, Switches, and Wireless access points. Use it as the sizing engine of record for Firewall/Switch intake and SE discussion. Pricing, terms, and some subscription SKUs still belong in CPQ/spreadsheet until fully mapped.

- Send a customer a guided multi-site questionnaire (Firewall / Switches / Wireless)
- Get Minimum / Recommended / Optimal model tiers plus a consolidated bill of materials (BOM)
- Hand off wireless / AP scoping to the Sophos presales wireless team (no fake AP BOM)
- Flag for SE review, notify the AM when reviewed or needs changes, then export

2. Roles

- Account Manager — creates links, sees only their own requests, flags for SE, exports after review
- Sales Engineer — sees all requests, SE review queue (flagged), marks reviewed / needs changes, can apply SE corrections
- Partner — magic-link access to create sizing links for their deals (sponsored by an SE)
- Admin — catalog admin, archive, and BOM recalculate after catalog changes

3. Creating and sharing a sizing link

From the dashboard, click "New link". Enter a customer label, vanity slug, contact name/email, and optional expiry. Copy the link and send it to your contact. Anyone on the same email domain can unlock the wizard after confirming their email.

Important: You receive an in-app notification (and email when configured) when the customer submits.

4. Flag !' SE Review !' export

- AM: open the submitted request, optionally add a note, click Flag for SE — the aligned SE is notified by default (optional Notify all SEs)
- SE: use the dashboard “SE queue” filter (review = flagged), open the request, work the checklist (opportunity ID, wireless handoff, sizing-only SKUs), add notes or a needs-changes template, then Mark reviewed or Needs changes
- AM is notified in-app (and by email when configured) when SE sets reviewed or needs_changes
- AM CSV / quote export stays locked until reviewStatus is reviewed (SEs can always export)

Important: Always complete SE review before pasting a BOM into CPQ. Treat the tool as sizing guidance until subscription/support SKUs are fully orderable.

5. Reading the recommendation

- Each site card shows binding constraint, why Recommended differs from Minimum, confidence (Green / Amber / Red), and sizing notes
- Minimum / Recommended / Optimal use capacity headroom bands ("e25% / "e50% throughput, or spare switch ports) — not catalog index +1/+2
- Catalog provenance (version, source, as-of) appears under Why this size

6. Resubmit and SE correction

- Allow customer resubmit — reopens the vanity link; prior BOM stays visible until they submit again, then the old version is archived
- SE correction — SE edits answers in-app, recalculates the BOM, archives the prior version, and marks the request reviewed
- Submission history on the request page lists archived versions (customer resubmit, SE correction, catalog recompute)

7. Partners

SEs invite partners from the Partners page with a one-time magic link. Partners sign in via email, create sizing links for their customers, and follow the same Flag !' SE review workflow. Partners do not manage the catalog.

8. Catalog admin (admins only)

Only admins can open Catalog admin to edit firewall/switch/accessory specs and SKUs, import CSV, view the audit trail, and recalculate BOMs for open submitted deals after catalog changes. Sales Engineers do not get catalog edit access.

9. Troubleshooting

- Wrong customer answers: Allow customer resubmit or use SE correction — do not create a duplicate link unless the slug must change
- Export disabled for AM: wait for SE Mark reviewed, or ask an SE to export
- Link expired or archived: create a new link, or unarchive (admin) if appropriate

- Email domain mismatch: contact email domain must match the customer's work domain